New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc.)

Minutes of 2013/14 Annual General Meeting
24th February 2014

Date: Monday 24th February 2014, 7.30 pm
Venue: 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Present: Peter Squires, Bill Kennedy, Emma de Lacey, Trevor Merrifield, Grant Hunter, Mondo Kopua (by phone link), Stuart Payne
Apologies: Tim Farrant, Jamie Stewart

Minutes of the 2012/13 AGM and matters arising
The minutes were adopted as a fair record of the meeting for the year ending February 2013. No substantive issues arising that were not covered in the current-year agenda.

President's Annual Report (appended below)
Peter Squires report highlighted the challenges in (1) sustaining championship 24 hour events to meet international standards and the balance of these events versus more accessible shorter events, and (2) evolving the structure of the Association to meet future local to national needs of rogaining in this country.

International Rogaine Federation reps report (viewable www.rogaine.org.nz)
Interactions with the IRF have covered hosting world championship events including regional rotations, and financial models for funding IRF, led by Nick Collins and Emma de Lacey. Bill Kennedy engaged with the IRF technical committee on rule changes and defining age groups for international competition.

Financial report (viewable www.rogaine.org.nz)
The Association had a favourable balance sheet, noting we received no revenue from Heights of Winter this year (organised by PAPO), nor incurred expenses in supporting a championship event (there was none in 2013). The bank account is at a favourable level.

Future structures and arrangements for NZRA
A motion (with sub-points) was put to the meeting "*That the NZRA reforms into regional entities (called Branches) and a core national body*." This formulation was based on agreement at the December 2013 committee meeting, in turn based on concerns expressed by Secretary Grant Hunter over a period of time that (1) at least from a secretarial perspective, the current structure was ambiguous on local versus national interests and (2) perceptions in some regions that NZRA was not delivering local benefits.

Pre-publication of this motion induced several submissions which collectively voiced an alternative model, to explore some form of amalgamation with orienteering through the NZ Orienteering Federation. (The secretary holds a collated set of responses.)

Further discussion at the AGM led to a revised proposal that both strands should be investigated, i.e., (1) developing a core national and regional branch structure and/or (2) greater collaboration with orienteering. (A fair summary is that valid cases have been advanced in the pre-meeting submissions and at the AGM for both. There tends to be a NI/SI

split, the former leaning towards links with orienteering, and the latter an independent rogaining association with a stronger regional presence.)

The original motion was rescinded and following motion was passed:

"That the NZRA facilitates the forming of regional entities (branches) where there is a desire for this, plus a core rogaining national body (being the NZRA), and also investigates working more closely with the NZ Orienteering Federation."

The intent of the meeting was that the new President be given a fairly long leash to lead communication with (1) NZ rogainers across the regions, in particular those who had responded to the draft motion and (2) counterparts in orienteering, particularly the rogaine subcommittee members of NZOF, and listen to views, form opportunities, and over time lead the formulation and implementation of future options.

Election of Officers

Given the uncertainty surrounding the future structure and function of the Association, the meeting agreed that the new committee for 2014 should continue to be based on the current model, recognising that changes are likely for next year, and with the possibility of transitional arrangements starting in the current year. The current committee comprises a 'central core', plus regional representatives who in 2008 were given full committee member status, pending any future restructuring.

The following appointments were confirmed through a nomination and seconding process, subject to individual agreements where noted. No voting was required.

**President*: Mondo Kopua (PS/DW)
Secretary: Grant Hunter (DW/TM) (transitional basis as new ways of operating are formulated)
Treasurer: Trevor Merrifield (PS/EL)
Committee: (re-instated as a block) Peter Squires, Emma de Lacey, Tim Farrant, Douglas Woods, Nick Collins (the latter subject to agreement)

Regional representatives:
(subject to agreement).

Auckland –Shaun Collins, Alastair McDowell
Taranaki – Annie Sanderson
Bay of Plenty/Central NI – Mark Copeland
Taupo – Darren Ashmore
Wellington –Jamie Stewart
Marlborough – Alan Holdaway
Central Otago – Ed Stevens
Otago – Bob Cunninghame, Matt Bixley

International Rogaining Federation (IRF) Representatives: Nick Collins, Emma de Lacey

Technical roles:

Webmaster and membership: Bill Kennedy
Facebook coordinator: Tim Farrant
Navlight: Jac Woudberg

Gear controller and Assets: Douglas Woods
NZ Champs liaison: Tim Farrant

*Note to the appointment of President
Recognising the Association's wish to re-energise and evolve to meet future needs, Mondo Kopua made himself available for a senior role. Mondo is recognised as an experienced rogainer as participant and organiser, and well informed on how rogaining operates both domestically and internationally, and with active links to orienteering. Current President Pete Squires welcomed this opportunity for rejuvenation within the presidency.

Thank you to the retiring President
Peter Squires was thanked for his pivotal role in rogaining in NZ, our international links, and in stimulating the formation of the Association. Since he initiated its formation in 2002 he has been the sole President.

We also acknowledged retiring committee member Davie Laurie who was also a founding member of Association. Dave continues to be available to help stage events.

Other business
Electronic communication
Agreed we need a system to enable national conversations, suggesting something like either a multi-party version of Skype or a product such as "GoTo". Mondo to follow up.

Public liability insurance
Grant noted that we need to be careful with event organiser relationships. He has revamped the policy agreement to permit cover for events that we co-organise, including where another party is the lead organiser, but at some point the relationship may be seen as too arms-length. We now need to advise the insurer of collaborative events on a one-by-one basis. Revise the policy at the May renewal.

Trophy recovery
Trevor Merrifield to follow up on trophy returns, bearing in mind some could be harder than normal to track given the two-year gap with no championship event in 2013.

NZRA website
Noted an intent to eventually redesign www.rogaine.org.nz and to update some content, the former which could be handled commercially. This should await any restructuring as needs may change. There is no urgency – Bill was complimented on his website design – it delivers current and future information plus archived results etc in a simple, no fuss and easy-to-navigate format.

NZ Champs
Venues and organisers are looking secured for three years to 2016

Meeting closed 9.30pm

Annual Report 2013 – 2014

This has been a challenging year for NZRA. We are still trying to find a structure which combines regions and local hot spots into an effective national body. There is increasing distinction of two 'levels' of rogaining and we need to think about how to support both, as well as flows between them. On one hand there are many rogaines being run by various groups and individuals in many regions, typically up to 6-hour duration. These rogaines attract strong participation across a wide range of people because of their variety, handy location, and manageable duration. On the other hand, we have the championship level 24 hour events that are important to keep Kiwis engaged and competitive in international competition. Organisationally, these events are much more demanding, requiring access to large tracts of land and demanding standards of course-setting, while participation is much lower. Many smaller, local events lack the formality and rigour which build the discipline for both organisers and participants to underpin championship-level rogaining. We need to find ways to improve the flows from the shorter to the longer events.

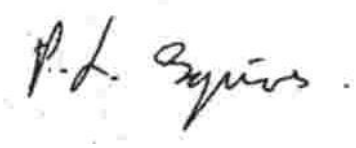
We were unable to run a national championship in 2013, due to a shortage of volunteers with enough time and suitable land access. Some people believe that we should change the format of the national championships from one full 24 hour event to a series of shorter, less formal events, some of which may perhaps involve other disciplines such as cycling or metrogaines. While these options may have more popular appeal, both with competitors and organisers, we also have to recognise that the 24 hour format is likely to continue to be the international standard.

The Australian Rogaining Championships, run annually by one of the State organisations in a rotation, are now the Australasian Championships – that is, they are combined with New Zealand. It is our turn to run the Australasian Championships in 2016. These championships must meet strict criteria of organisation, vetting, and quality, and we risk losing the ability to provide this if we do not continue to have our own national championships.

We need a better and easier way of combining information and resources than the existing Committee structure. Perhaps if we re-form into local groups, there may be a better communication within each group, which may encourage more participation by new, younger volunteers. Rogaining has been built on the volunteer system as an underlying principle, but to continue, we need more and younger volunteers.

We may also need to look at our membership model again. A Subscription-based membership would at least ensure that our list was up-to-date, but would impose an additional administrative burden. However it may allow people to feel that they "own" the club, and may encourage them to participate more in organisation and planning of events.

Best wishes for a full rogaining year.



Peter Squires, President. 19th February, 2014